Baked Ziti

DAIRY ✓ LEFTOVERS

Prep — Cook **42 min** Total **42 min** Serves —



Ingredients

- **1 box (1 lb/500 g)** penne pasta
- **2 Tbsp** kosher salt, divided
- **2 (15 oz) cans** tomato sauce (marinara)
- **¼ cup** ricotta cheese (changed to ½)
- **3 Tbsp** unsalted butter, cubed, divided
- **4 cups** shredded mozzarella cheese, divided
- **1 tsp** coarsely ground black pepper
- **½ tsp** crushed red pepper flakes, optional

Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F.
2. Bring a large pot of water to a boil. Add 1 tablespoon salt and pasta.
3. Meanwhile, butter a 9x13 inch baking dish or aluminum pan.
4. Directly into the pan add tomato sauce, ricotta cheese, 2 tablespoons butter, 2 cups shredded cheese, remaining salt, pepper, and red pepper flakes.
5. Before draining pasta, remove ½ cup pasta water and add to the pan, stirring to combine.
6. Drain pasta. Add cooked pasta to the pan and stir to fully coat every single piece.
7. Top mixture with remaining 2 cups shredded cheese.
8. Dot the remaining tablespoon of cubed butter over the top.
9. Bake for 40-45 minutes until the top is golden brown and bubbly.
10. Serve hot and enjoy!